

Reveal Games — the What

0. The business plan in ten lines (state on 13 Sep 2026)

1. **Product:** The Proposal — a \$299 hand-directed 15–20 min browser game about the couple; the last door is the question. One product. (\$1, \$11)
2. **Proof:** Les Portes and Aurélie's reaction (with her OK) — the story is the marketing. (\$7)
3. **Buyer:** someone about to propose; plans 2–12 months ahead, spends ~\$3k, films the moment anyway. (\$13)
4. **Why not GameQ:** they sell "you, in a game" in 30 minutes, kids-led; we sell the reveal and the direction, which their model can't produce. (\$1)
5. **Why now:** Les Portes' first playable version took 23 minutes of agent work; the cost is in the personal detail, which is what's sold. (\$8)
6. **Form:** asks for the relationship and the moment, not the person's stats; ~10 min, no photo, avatar cast. (\$2b)
7. **Channels:** story video (core) + Etsy as a service + Pinterest/YouTube/Reddit background; €50 Etsy Ads then €150 boost. (\$14)
8. **Demand signal:** paid orders at list price. Nothing else counts. (\$11)
9. **Money:** ~\$284 net per order; 10 orders/month ≈ €2.6k at ~40h; season Nov–Feb doubles it. (\$9)
10. **Kill rule:** no paid order by ~15 Nov → stop, ≤€200 and ~60h spent. (\$14)

Scope of this document: what the business is, how a customer experiences it, why it can win, and what the money looks like. **No timeline, no build plan** — those come only once this convinces.

Lean principle (Pascal, 13 Sep): find the right idea, the right way to expose it, and see who wants it. First orders are fulfilled by hand (Pascal + Claude); automation only once customers are actually requesting games.

Where this stands

Pascal built **Les Portes** for Aurélie's 42nd: a browser game where she bakes her real products while the girls cause chaos, and each recipe opens a door to a real gift she chooses. He wants a business around it.

Locked (12–13 Sep 2026): side income first (~€2–5k/month) · 10–20h/week · ≤€500 to test · free tiers by default · English only · voice-only content · Les Portes is the public demo (with Aurélie's OK) · real payments are fine, invoicing parked.

Pascal's steer (13 Sep): the customer must feel they are *making* the game in a semi-automated way, with the least possible human interaction — no calls, no "pure dev service". Templated games where people add their **faces, words and actions**. Possibly Android, not only browser.

Decided 13 Sep: avatar builder only at launch · both tiers in one funnel · Chaos Kitchen first · Android is not part of the business plan (revisit on demand) · hand-fulfilled first, automate on demand.

1. The offer

The promise on the page:

A 20-minute game about their life — where the people they love do what they really do, and the ending happens for real.

They get	Concretely
Them as the hero	Avatar built in 30 seconds (hair, glasses, outfit); their name on the title screen
Their people as the cast — with behaviours	Up to 6 people/pets. Not cameos: each one <i>does</i> something true — the toddler steals what you're carrying, the dog blockades the fridge, mum calls at the worst moment, the best friend is late to every level
Their world as the level	Their kitchen, flat, city, the trip. Their favourite things as the objectives (Aurélie baked her own product catalogue)
Their words inside the game	Inside jokes as dialogue, hints, item names, the boss's taunts — natural, correct English (or their language)
An ending that happens for real	The last door opens on: the question, the ultrasound, the tickets, a video — or doors to <i>real</i> gifts they choose. The game is the wrapping for a moment
Zero friction	Private browser link, phone-first, nothing to install, replayable forever, printable QR gift card
Made to be finished	Hints, a mercy valve, no soft-locks — a non-gamer completes it in 15–25 minutes

Mechanically it is a guided builder (template → cast → words → actions → reveal → play level 1 → pay); see §2. Under the lean rule the first orders are built by hand behind that same form.

GameQ, seen properly (Playwright walk of gameq.gg, 13 Sep 2026)

My earlier read of GameQ came from a text fetch of a JS-rendered page and was wrong in several rows. The real thing, captured step by step (screenshots and dumps in the session scratchpad, `gameq/`):

- **Company:** GameQ Labs Inc., Delaware (1209 Orange St, Wilmington — a registered-agent address); "built in the United States, founded by a creator from Sweden". Terms: "AI-generated game output is inherently variable"; one free regeneration; all sales final after that.
- **Ladder:** Spark **\$79** (3 genres · 3 levels · name, story, message · 3 collectibles) → Story **\$159** "most gifted" (5 levels · their face as the hero · 5 collectibles) → Epic **\$279** (8 levels · 3 bosses · sidekick as cheering NPC · custom villain = what they hate) → Legend **\$399** (10+ levels · 4+ bosses · two-hero mode · "place-based level — their town becomes the setting"). Running a 30%-off code this week.
- **Occasion presets** route to a tier: kid's birthday \$159, milestone birthday \$279, anniversary/couple \$399, big win \$279, just-because \$79.
- **10 genres**, tier-gated, 2D and 3D: platformer, endless runner, school adventure, puzzle pack (match-3 + photo jigsaw), storybook adventure, sports, arcade racing, 3D kart, 3D adventure ("open world — biggest wow factor"), foam-dart shooter. Ages 3+ to 10+.
- **Generation in 30–60 min** after payment; preview of the stylised portrait, details and message *before* paying; **no photo needed** ("description-based fallback"); photos auto-deleted in 30 days; COPPA consent step for children.
- **Delivery:** private link, PWA (home-screen install, offline), lifetime, scheduled delivery by email on a chosen date, voice message add-on \$29, closing message "shown at game end".
- **Proof:** "5.0 · 14 verified reviews" (all birthdays / kids), 6 playable examples in an arcade (the example is a mobile-portrait title card + Play; the game itself sits in a sandboxed iframe), a demo level on the home page.
- **Channels already built:** influencer programme (20%), **school fundraising** (schools earn 30%; their own calculator assumes ~\$14.70 to the school per gift, i.e. ~\$49 average order), SEO blog posts dated 12–13 Sep 2026, live support chat.
- **Positioning drift:** almost everything on the page is **kids** — 12-year-olds, back to school, "the kid who has everything", school worlds. Adult emotional occasions (anniversary, proposal) are one \$399 preset with no example.

Verdict: GameQ is a polished, actively developed, automated product with a full price ladder up to \$399. Three of my claimed differentiators were wrong: they *do* have a sidekick/pet, a villain

from dislikes, favourite things as collectibles and level names, a place-based setting, and an end-of-game message. What they don't have — and what the walk confirms — is below.

What is genuinely left to differentiate on

	GameQ (real)	Reveal Games
Form asks about	the person's attributes : age, gender, colour, 3 adjectives, favourite things, one sidekick	the relationship and the moment : how you met, a normal day, who does what, what has to happen at the end
Output	a genre skin — a platformer/runner/kart with their face, their collectibles, their level names	a story — 15–25 min whose scenes are their life, ending in a real-world reveal
Cast	1 hero (+1 co-hero at \$399), 1 cheering sidekick, 1 villain	up to 6 people/pets, each with a true behaviour as a mechanic
The ending	a closing message	the reveal : the question, the news, the tickets, doors to real gifts
Audience	kids and families	adults giving to adults — proposals, anniversaries, milestone birthdays, announcements
Likeness	AI photo → 3D/cel-shaded hero (their edge)	avatar builder, no photos (privacy, zero prep)
Speed	30–60 min	2–7 days, hand-directed
Preview before pay	yes	no at first (hand-built) — mitigated by the playable Les Portes demo and a refund-if-preview-disappoints promise
Proof	14 reviews, 6 examples	one real game and one real reaction

Honest conclusion. "The same format with more questions" would lose: they generate in 30 minutes what we'd hand-build in days, with more genres, 3D, reviews, affiliates and a school channel. The only defensible product is a **different thing on the same delivery**: bespoke story-and-reveal games for adult emotional moments, where the form is *shorter in fields but deeper in story*, and the human direction is the product, not a cost to hide. That is the \$299 tier only — the templated \$79–149 tier competes head-on with Spark/Story and should not launch (see §6).

2. How the customer experiences it (the semi-automated flow)

This is the experience we *promise and show*. **Lean version:** the builder is a simple order form plus the playable Les Portes demo; steps 3–7 are done by hand by Pascal + Claude until repeated orders justify automating them. The customer still never books a call.

Everything happens inside the builder. No forms sent by email, no scheduling, no back-and-forth unless they want it.

Step	What they do	What they see	Automation
1. Template	Pick one of 3	30-second trailer of each	Fully automated
2. Cast (faces)	Add characters: name, role (hero, partner, kids, dog, "the villain"), look	The sprite appears on the game canvas immediately	Avatar builder: automated. Photo → stylised sprite: AI (see \$4)
3. Words	Answer 8–12 prompts: places, inside jokes, favourite things, the thing they always say, the ending message	AI drafts every line of dialogue, hint and caption from their answers; each line is editable inline	AI, automated
4. Actions	Pick 3–5 events from the template's menu and assign who does them ("the dog steals the ring", "mum calls at the worst moment", "the kids fight")	One event plays out in the preview	Automated (events are data, as in Les Portes' <code>KID_EVENTS</code>)
5. Reveal	Choose the ending: message, photo/video, "will you marry me?", trip destination, "choose your gift" doors — and fill it in	The ending scene renders in the preview	Automated
6. Try → pay	Play level 1 free in the browser	Full game unlocks after payment	Automated; checkout by a merchant-of-record (handles VAT)
7. Deliver	Private link + printable QR card + "Add to home screen" (app icon on the phone)	Nothing to install	Automated
8. Revise	Re-open the builder, change any text or event, regenerate	New version at the same link	Automated

2b. What the buyer provides — GameQ's real form vs ours

GameQ's order flow, exactly as captured (5 steps, ~5 min):

Step	Fields (• required)
1 · About them	• plan (Spark/Story/Epic/Legend) · • name (≤ 30) · • age · • occasion (9-item dropdown) · • boy/girl · • favourite colour · • "describe them in a few words" (≤ 120) · • favourite things (≤ 100 — "included in the theme, collectibles, and level names") · inside jokes & little details (≤ 300) · sidekick/pet/best friend: name + who they are
2 · Game type	• one of 10 genres (tier-gated, age-rated, 2D/3D)
3 · Your message	• message shown in the game (10–500 chars) · closing message shown at game end · delivery date (they email the link that morning) · recipient email · • from · • your email · ☐ voice message +\$29
4 · Photo	• photo (JPEG/PNG ≤ 15 MB, "face-fit detection"; description fallback exists) · • art style: 3D "Pixar-adjacent" or cel-shaded "video game"
5 · Review	preview of portrait, details and message → pay → game in 30–60 min

Ours (one product, ~10 min, no photo): same shape — a questionnaire and a link — but it asks for the *story and the moment*, not the person's stats.

Step	We ask (• required)	Worked example (Les Portes)
1 · The moment	• occasion · • the date it must be ready · • what happens at the end: the question / the news / the trip / doors to real gifts / a message or video	Birthday · 12 Sep · 5 doors to real gifts
2 · Them	• name · • avatar (hair, skin, glasses, outfit — 30 s) · • three words · • three things they love doing or making · language · gamer or not	Aur�lie · dark hair, apron · "her 5 real products" · French · plays games
3 · The cast (1–6)	• name · • relation · avatar · one true behaviour (menu) · one line they'd say	Emiko: "wants attention until she gets a cookie", " <i>Maman, regarde!</i> " · Yumi: "grabs what you're holding and runs"
4 · Your story	• 10 lines, free text, prompted: how a normal day goes · the jokes only you two get · what you want them to feel at the end · anything the game must never say	the execution diagnosis; "no sugar jokes"
5 · Delivery	• from · • your email · their email (optional) · ☐ you may use our reaction video	—

Step	We ask (● required)	Worked example (Les Portes)
After pay	within 48h a preview link (title, cast in the level, one behaviour playing) to approve · full game ≤7 days · 2 revisions on the same page	—

The difference in one line: GameQ asks *who they are* and generates a genre around it; we ask *what happened between you and what has to happen at the end*, and direct a story around it. Fewer fields than GameQ's step 1, one free-text box more. The cost is speed and pre-pay preview; the gain is the thing GameQ's automation can't produce.

2c. How we differentiate the *selling format* — not with more questions

Pascal's challenge: "so how do we differentiate without more questions — same format, more questions?" No. Five format changes, none of which is a longer form:

Format element	GameQ	Ours	Why it matters
The aisle it's sold in	"personalized game gifts" — next to toys, birthday presents, school fundraisers	"proposal planning" — next to secret-proposal photographers (\$425–815), planners, ring boxes	Same buyer, different mindset and price anchor. In the gift aisle \$299 is expensive; in the proposal aisle it's the cheapest line item
Intake	a 5-step form of attributes	a conversation: 6 core questions, then AI follow-ups on <i>their</i> answers ("you said she always says 'five more minutes' — when?"), capped at 10 min	Depth comes from follow-ups, not field count. The buyer feels heard, not interrogated
Preview	a stylised portrait + your message, before paying	a playable level 1 with their cast and one behaviour , for a \$99 deposit (credited), within 72h; the \$200 balance unlocks the full game	They <i>play it</i> before most of the money moves. GameQ's FAQ: "you see the stylized portrait, the personalisation details, and the sender message" — never gameplay. The deposit filters tyre-kickers and funds the hour the preview costs

Format element	GameQ	Ours	Why it matters
Delivery	a link + a gift-message page	the link plus the event kit : a printable QR card (the Les Portes reveal), a one-page "how to run the moment" (where, when, what to say when the last door opens), and an optional brief for their photographer	A proposal is a live event, not a download. GameQ delivers a file; we deliver the moment
Who makes it	invisible pipeline, 30 minutes	a named designer who messages inside the order page ("I've added the cat; can I use the bar's real name?")	The direction <i>is</i> the product, so the buyer must see it. GameQ can't offer this at 30 minutes

Plan to tackle GameQ, in order: (1) never list next to them — proposal-planning framing everywhere (Etsy category *Marriage proposal*, video hooks about *the moment*, not *the game*); (2) the playable preview for a deposit is the headline promise on the order page; (3) every delivered proposal produces a reaction clip (with permission) — the asset GameQ's kids' birthdays can't match; (4) if GameQ adds a "Proposal" preset, we say so out loud: "theirs is 30 minutes and a portrait; ours is a person building your moment" — and the reaction clips carry the argument.

Intake time stays ≤10 minutes. Six core questions (the moment · them · the cast · the story in 10 lines · delivery · reaction permission), then at most 5 follow-ups, all skippable.

Directed tier only (step 6b): the builder sends the brief to the "design desk". A Claude agent deepens the game from the brief — custom events written from their story, native-language polish, playtest — and Pascal checks it before it goes out. Delivered in 48h–7 days. The buyer gets a message inside the builder, not a call. This uses the same autonomous-queue machinery Pascal already runs for his games (`bt-chain` pattern): order in → agent builds → deploy → notify.

Where humans are: zero on the self-serve tier; ≤2–4h of Pascal's review on the directed tier; content creation. That's it.

3. The catalogue at launch — 3 templates

Each template is a data pack for one engine (the Les Portes engine already separates `RECIPES`, `DOORS`, `ROOMS`, `CHARS`, `KID_EVENTS`, `SCENES` into data). Each exposes the same four slots: **faces** · **words** · **actions** · **reveal**.

Template	Story	Occasions	Actions menu (examples)	Reveal
Chaos Kitchen (= Les Portes)	Cook their real favourites while the family causes chaos; each dish opens a door	Birthdays, Mother's/Father's Day, anniversaries	Kid steals, kid cries when the oven's on, siblings fight, dog blockades the fridge	Doors to messages, photos, or <i>real</i> gifts to choose from
The Quest	Walk the places of their life (the bar where you met, the flat, the trip), each level a memory, a boss at the end	Proposals, big anniversaries	Ex-boss chases, the friend who's always late, the cat that ruins everything	Ring moment / "will you marry me?" / anniversary letter
Mission: Reveal	A short spy-style mission; each puzzle unlocks part of the secret	Pregnancy, trip, gift and gender reveals; "you're going to be grandparents"	The nosy neighbour, the dog that eats the clue, the phone that won't stop	The news, the destination, the ultrasound, the tickets

New templates later are data packs, not new products. Candidates: **Level Up** (kids' birthdays, the child is the hero), **Last Day** (farewell/retirement, colleagues add lines), **Save the Date** (wedding guests).

Cast invites (phase 2, but part of the "what"): the buyer can send a link so friends and family add themselves as characters and type one line each. Every contributor sees the product. This is exactly how VidDay reached \$1M/year with no ads, and Kudoboard \$2.4M.

4. Faces, words, actions — how each is actually done

Faces. Avatar builder only at launch (decided 13 Sep); photo-stylised sprites are a later option: - **Avatar builder (default, automated, instant):** hair, skin, glasses, outfit, accessory → top-down sprite, Les Portes-style (no facial features, so it reads right at small sizes and there are no photos of children to store). Deterministic, free, zero privacy exposure. - **Photo → stylised sprite (premium option):** Cloudflare Workers AI has `stable-diffusion-v1-5-img2img` on the free tier Pascal already uses; docs cite "a cartoon version of a portrait" as the use case. **Likeness quality is unverified** — must be tested before it is promised. GameQ sells exactly this ("animated-movie version of them") at \$79, so it is feasible at some quality level.

Words. The buyer's answers → an LLM drafts dialogue, hints, captions, the ending. Editable line by line. Language is a first-class field (English at launch; French/Spanish/Dutch are a prompt

change, not a build).

Actions. Each template ships a menu of 8–12 events; the buyer picks and assigns. Les Portes already runs this as data (`KID_EVENTS` , `CHAOS_ROTATION` , soft-lock guards: stolen items drop after 20s, blockades clear after 90s). New events per template are the main design work.

Reveal. The `DOORS` / `ROOMS` / `SCENES` structure already supports "doors that open to something". Message, media, and choose-your-gift are variants of the same scene.

5. Platforms — browser, and Android

Channel	What it gives	Cost / friction
Browser link (PWA) — default	Plays on any phone/laptop; "Add to home screen" puts an app icon on Android <i>and</i> iPhone; works offline after first load	None. This is the delivery for every order
One Android "player" app on Google Play	A real store listing ("Reveal Games — play your gift"); app icon, notifications, Play-store discovery; the customer enters their code or link	Built as a Trusted Web Activity wrapping the PWA — the standard route (VidDay's Android app is literally <code>com.vidday.share.twa</code>). Play accepts TWAs of a real PWA (Lighthouse ≥80, Digital Asset Links); raw WebView wrappers get rejected under policy 4.3. Pascal's account is subject to the 12 testers / 14 days closed-test gate he already knows from BlewTD
One app per customer	—	No. Sideloaded .apk/.exe is what makes Muksun feel clunky; a per-customer Play listing is impossible at this price
Unity build	—	Not for this. Unity WebGL is heavy on phones; the HTML5 engine already exists and is the right tool for a link-delivered 20-minute game

Decided 13 Sep: browser/PWA for every order. The Android player app is an execution question, not a business one — revisit only if customers ask for it.

6. Price — what the analysis says

Anchors (corrected after the GameQ walk): GameQ ladder **\$79 / \$159 / \$279 / \$399**, automated, 14 verified reviews (kids) · Muksun \$99 sale / \$189.99 list · Songfinch **\$200** (human-

made emotional gift that scaled to ~\$75M) · NRF Valentine's spend **\$199.78 per person** · DIY proposal extras \$200–600 · Heartbit \$599+ (unproven). The earlier claim "no evidence of orders above \$190" is withdrawn: GameQ lists \$279/\$399 and its occasion presets push adult buyers to \$399.

What this does to the two-tier plan. A templated \$149 tier sits between GameQ Spark (\$79, 30 min, 3 levels) and Story (\$159, their face as hero, 5 levels) with slower delivery and no photo likeness — it loses on their terms. Recommendation: **launch one product.**

Product	Price	What's in it	Human time
Made with you (the only tier at launch)	\$299	A 15–25 min story game directed by a human: cast of up to 6 with true behaviours · their life as the level · their words in-game · a real-world reveal (question / news / trip / real-gift doors) · preview link in 48h · 2 revisions · guaranteed date · link + QR card	~4h
Add-on: voice line from you at the end	+\$29	Matches GameQ's add-on; trivial to deliver	—

Why \$299. Under GameQ's Legend (\$399, the tier their adult "anniversary/couple" preset lands on), above their Epic (\$279), in the Songfinch/Valentine's zone, and 5–20% of a typical proposal budget. It is the number the "paid orders at list price" test validates. No founding discounts; a reaction-video permission is a checkbox, not a price cut. The \$79 templated tier returns only if the builder is automated *and* GameQ hasn't moved into story/reveal by then.

7. Who buys, and where they come from (with evidence grades)

Buyers: partners giving a milestone gift (birthday, anniversary, proposal), and couples/parents announcing something (pregnancy, trip, baby's gender). English-speaking, 25–45, comfortable with a phone game. The recipient must *enjoy* a 20-minute game, so the games are easy, phone-first, and story-led — the opposite of Les Portes' keyboard difficulty, which was right for Aurélie only.

Channel	Evidence	Grade
Story videos (TikTok/Reels/Shorts, Pascal's voiceover over Les Portes footage): "I made my wife a video game for her birthday"	Three DIY versions of this exact story went viral: Knight Man proposal (~1.5M views), ABC News proposal game , McBee's birthday game (Feb 2025, millions of views). Attention is proven; conversion to orders is not	B
Cast invites (built-in spread)	VidDay: \$80k/month, 90% margin, bootstrapped, "every participant a potential superfan"; Kudoboard \$2.4M/yr	B (once built)
Paid ads on the best video	Crown & Paw: \$11M year one from transformation/reaction ads. Cost per order unknown for us	B as a measurement, not a channel yet
Life-event SEO pages ("proposal ideas", "pregnancy announcement ideas")	VidDay grew on one page per life event. But Pampers, The Bump and Canva hold those keywords	C — slow
Etsy	Correction of my earlier claim: I have no search-volume data . Etsy's "custom video game gift" market pages are mostly merch (blankets, mugs, cases). Playable-game sellers there are few, with tens of reviews. Demand exists but is small	C — cheap secondary listing, not a channel to count on
Planner / venue partners	Only ~2% of proposers use a planner; needs outreach, which drains Pascal	C — later, if ever

The honest core of the bet: attention for this story is proven; whether strangers *pay* is the one thing nobody in the category has demonstrated at scale. That is what a test must measure, and nothing else.

8. Why this can win

- Depth at a template price.** For 15 years the choice was hand-made (Amuze Me €1–50k, dead) or generic templates (Greeting Games, ~\$145k/yr). AI removes the trade-off: Les Portes' first playable version took **23 minutes** of agent work; the days after were personal detail — the part customers value. Nobody at \$79 offers a 20-minute story with cast, actions and a reveal.
- The reveal is the product.** Every competitor sells "a game with your face". We sell the *moment*: the door that opens on the ring, the trip, the news. That's what the viral stories were about.

- 3. **The factory exists.** Pascal already runs autonomous agent queues that build, test and deploy games (`bt-chain`). Order fulfilment is the same shape.
- 4. **The story exists.** A true, filmable founder story with a working game and (with her OK) a real reaction. The three viral cases were people who spent months coding; we can say "I did this for my wife — now you can, in 20 minutes".
- 5. **Language is a prompt, not a build.** French/Spanish/Dutch open later at near-zero cost; competitors are English-only or dead (the French ComeUp gig: 1 sale in 15 months).

What could kill it

Risk	Grade	Answer
Strangers don't pay, even when they watch	Critical	The only thing to test; hard stop rules when the test is designed
Category has never scaled; GameQ/MiniGameGift show tiny traffic	High	Target is 30–50 orders/month, not scale; the reveal + story + cast-invites are the differences
GameQ or Astrocade (\$56M raised) add "story + reveal"	Medium	Speed and taste, not moat; the brand is the story
Pascal's time (the Etsy shop died of it)	High	Self-serve tier needs none; directed tier capped by a waitlist
Photo-likeness quality on free AI	Medium	Avatar builder is the default; photo sprites only after a real test
Recipient doesn't want to play	Medium	15–25 min, easy, hints + mercy + skip (all already in Les Portes)

9. The money

Per order (hand-made phase): \$149 → ~\$141 net of a 5%+50¢ merchant-of-record fee (Lemon Squeezy/Paddle) · \$299 → ~\$284. Hosting €0 (GitHub/Cloudflare Pages), art €0 (free FLUX tier via `gen_media.py`), generation on Claude quota.

Mix	Orders / month	Net / month	Pascal hours / month
Hand-made, quiet month	10 × \$149 + 5 × \$299	~€2.6k	~40

Mix	Orders / month	Net / month	Pascal hours / month
Hand-made, peak (Dec–Feb, when 47% of proposals happen)	2×	~€5k	~80 — needs a waitlist, or the builder
Automated later	40 × \$79 + 8 × \$299	~€5k	~32

Capacity: self-serve unlimited; directed ≤20/month at 20h/week.

What ~15 orders/month needs in traffic (assumption ranges, to be measured — bio-link benchmarks for cheap goods are 3–8% click and ~3% buy; a \$149–299 purchase converts lower):

Case	Views → visit	Visit → order	Views for 15 orders
Low	0.1%	0.5%	~3M
High	0.5%	2%	~150k

One video in this niche reaching 1M+ views is realistic; sustaining 150k–3M views a month is the open question, which is why cast invites and paid ads sit in the "what".

Seasonality: 16–19% of proposals are in December (Christmas Eve/Day are the top 2 days); ~47% fall between Thanksgiving and Valentine's Day; Mother's Day, Father's Day and the summer wedding season fill the rest.

10. Rejected shapes (so they stay rejected)

- **Booking a call / pure dev service:** Pascal's time as the product, no leverage, and it's what BdayGame and Amuze Me did.
 - **One app per customer:** delivery friction killed Save the Date! and makes Muksun clunky.
 - **Bespoke-only at \$300+:** no evidence of demand at that price yet — keep it as the upsell, not the anchor.
 - **Branded marketing games for companies:** saturated SaaS (BMG \$0–119/month, Adact, Qualifio).
 - **Physical box editions:** fulfilment is what killed the Etsy shop.
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11. Decided (13 Sep)

- **LOCKED (later on 13 Sep, after the study and the deeper dig): one product — The Proposal, \$299, hand-directed, the last door is the question.** Chaos Kitchen (Les Portes) is the proof and the story, not a product. Save the Date only after a proposal sells and a buyer asks. Supersedes the two lines below.
- Faces: avatar builder only.
- ~~Tiers: both, one funnel.~~ → one product.
- ~~First template: Chaos Kitchen.~~ → The Proposal.
- Android: not in the business plan; on demand.
- Fulfilment: by hand first (Pascal + Claude); automate once requests repeat.

12. Lean logic — the order of proof

1. **The idea** — §1: a personal game with a reveal, templated, \$79 / \$249.
2. **The exposure** — the true story plus the playable demo, put where the audience is (open: which channel first).
3. **The demand signal** — real requests: paid orders, or at least completed order forms with an occasion and a date. Not likes, not views.
4. **Only then** — automate the builder, add templates, consider Android.

Still open (business, not execution): which exposure to try first, what counts as "someone wants it", and the price shown at exposure.

13. The study — which way, and why (13 Sep)

Pascal asked for the smartest move among: (A) single \$299 story+reveal tier for adult moments, (B) keep two tiers, (C) stop, (D) pivot the audience to a niche GameQ ignores. Scored on what matters for a side business with no outreach: proven demand, a **built-in channel**, defensibility vs GameQ, fit with what Les Portes already does, money per order, and time to a first paid signal.

	Demand evidence	Built-in channel	vs GameQ	Les Portes fit	\$/order	First signal
A · adult moments, broad	medium (Songfinch analog)	none — content only	thin: a dropdown item away	good	\$299	slow

	Demand evidence	Built-in channel	vs GameQ	Les Portes fit	\$/order	First signal
B · two tiers	low tier loses to Spark/Story	none	loses	—	\$149/\$299	slow
C · stop	—	—	—	—	0	—
D · couples: proposal → save-the-date → wedding	strong (below)	two (below)	structural	exact (reveal doors, cast, chaos)	\$299–499	Nov–Dec

Why D — the evidence:

1. **Proposals.** No "proposal game" service exists anywhere (searched; only B2B proposal templates come back). The format is proven by the DIY viral cases (Knight Man ~1.5M views, ABC/NBC coverage, TikTok has a "video game proposal ideas" topic). The buyer plans 2–12 months ahead, spends ~\$3k on average, and **the reaction gets filmed anyway**: 20% hire a secret photographer, ~75% post the engagement within two days ([WeddingPro](#), [The Knot](#)). Every order produces the marketing asset. 47% of proposals fall Thanksgiving → Valentine's; that window opens in ~10 weeks.
2. **Save-the-dates / invitations.** Couples spend **\$518** on the paper suite and **\$153** on save-the-dates alone ([The Knot via Joy](#)); ~50% run a wedding website. Novelty digital invites sell at volume on Etsy: one animated-video-invitation seller has **19,000+ sales and 2,700 reviews**. Wedding-invite games exist only as one-off DIY builds (2012, 2019, 2023) and the one company that tried ([Save the Date!](#), 2019) died of app-download friction and 2020 — a browser link is exactly the fix. **Each order is played by ~100 guests**, some of them engaged — the VidDay contributor-virality mechanism, built in.
3. **GameQ is structurally elsewhere.** Kids-led, "family-friendly worlds, always", hero-centric, 30-minute genre skins, two heroes only at \$399, no proposal preset, no adult example, their blog never mentions proposals or weddings. A guest-facing game with the couple as characters and RSVP inside it is a different product, not a different price point.
4. **It is Les Portes with the nouns changed.** Cast with behaviours (the wedding party, the dog, the mother-in-law), a chaos loop, doors that open on something real — the date and venue, the RSVP, and at the end, the ring.

The move: one audience — *couples on the road to marriage* — and two products on the same engine:

Product	Price	What it is	Who plays
The Proposal	\$299	15–20 min story of the two of you; the last door is the question	one person
Save the Date	\$399 (unlimited guests)	the couple's story as a short game; doors open on date, venue, hotel; RSVP inside the game	~100 guests
Reception game (later)	\$199 add-on	a 5-minute table game with the guests as characters	the room

Exposure that needs no outreach: an Etsy shop in the wedding category (proven buyers, proven novelty-digital demand), the story video (Les Portes as proof; every proposal delivered adds a reaction clip with permission), and wedding-website SEO ("unique save the date ideas", "interactive wedding invitation"). Guests do the rest.

What this changes in the earlier decisions: Chaos Kitchen stays as the *proof* (the demo and the story), but the first two templates become **The Proposal** and **Save the Date**. One price band (\$299–399), hand-directed, no \$79–149 tier.

What kills it, honestly: (i) Etsy wedding buyers are anchored at \$10–30 templates — a \$399 listing may not convert there even though couples spend \$500+ on stationery elsewhere; (ii) couples may want "pretty", not "a game"; (iii) GameQ adds a proposal preset (cheap for them, but still a genre skin, not a reveal). The paid-orders test measures (i) and (ii) directly; (iii) is why the product must be the reveal and the cast, never the likeness.

Deeper dig on the three kill risks (13 Sep, after "not convinced")

Risk	What I verified	Verdict
(i) Etsy price anchoring at \$10–30	Etsy itself rate-limited the scan (home IP, "access temporarily restricted" — stopped, not retried). From Google-indexed listings: custom wedding-website <i>services</i> on Etsy sell at \$139–\$495 with 5-star reviews (StandishDesignStudio \$295 list, WixWebsiteProDesign \$199 list); animated-invitation + stationery packages at \$320; bespoke invitation design runs \$75–\$1,500+. Templates are \$10–30; <i>services</i> are \$140–500.	Mitigated. \$299–399 is inside what Etsy wedding buyers already pay for a custom digital service, as long as it's listed as a service, not a template.

Risk	What I verified	Verdict
(ii) "Pretty, not a game"	Game invitations are real but rare: the 2012 Katie & Barry game (Game Informer + TODAY — same couple, I had double-counted it), a 2023 DIY site, a 2024 hardware badge. The only company that tried, Save the Date! (2019), never launched — its Kickstarter is still "coming soon" on itch.io, so there is no market test either way. Google autocomplete does offer "save the date video game" and "interactive wedding invitation website / digital". No wedding survey measures gamer-themed weddings. GameQ's blog now carries two <i>anniversary</i> articles — they are drifting toward couples.	Real, and it splits the two products. Save the Date is a gamer-couple niche inside weddings with no proof anyone pays; The Proposal is reveal-first, bought by one person, needs no guest to "get it", and Google suggests "video game marriage proposal" unprompted.
(iii) GameQ copies	They have Wedding/Anniversary/Valentine's in the dropdown, anniversary content on the blog, a \$399 two-hero tier. Adding a "Proposal" preset costs them an afternoon. What they can't add cheaply is a hand-directed story with a choreographed reveal and cast behaviours — their whole model is 30-minute generation.	Accepted. The defence is never the feature list; it is the reveal, the direction, and the reaction clips.

Revised move after the dig: lead with **The Proposal only** (\$299). Save the Date becomes the *second* product, built only after a proposal has sold and only if a buyer asks for the wedding follow-on (that ask is itself the demand test). This keeps the couples audience, the season (Nov–Feb), the reaction loop and Etsy as a channel, and drops the one product with no evidence that anyone pays.

Why not C. Stopping is right if no option has a channel. D has two, plus a self-producing reaction asset, and the test costs $\leq \text{€}200$. Stopping before that test throws away the one real asset — a finished, proven game and a true story — for nothing.

14. Exposure analysis — The Proposal, \$299 (13 Sep)

The season sets the clock. 47% of proposals fall Thanksgiving → Valentine's; Christmas Eve/Day are the top two days. With 7-day hand builds, Christmas orders must land by ~15 Dec, and proposers plan 2–12 months ahead — so exposure has to be live by **early November**, ideally mid-October. Everything below is scored against that.

Prerequisite for any channel: a Proposal demo — a fictional couple's game with the ring moment at the end (Les Portes is the *story*, but you can't show a real proposal game before one has been used). Hand-built from the Les Portes engine, ~2 days; produces the trailer, the Etsy video, the pins and the ad creative. Not automation — one demo.

Channel	Evidence	What it needs	Cost	Order maths	Signal in	Pascal h/wk
Story video (TikTok / Reels / Shorts, voice-only)	#proposal 23.4B views, 639k posts; #engagement 23.7B; small accounts average 4.2% engagement; three DIY versions of this story went viral	20 videos over 6 weeks: the true story (Les Portes + reaction, with Aurélie's OK), "what the last door opened on", the proposal demo, "how it works"; a link to the order page	€0	1 order per ~10k–200k views (0.1–0.5% click × 0.5–2% order)	4–6 weeks	3–4 (record, post, reply)
Etsy, listed as a service	"proposal scavenger hunt" is a real Etsy category; custom digital services sell at \$139–495; Etsy Ads CPC \$0.20–0.50	one listing: "Custom proposal video game — made to order, private link"; demo video + 5 images; €50 ad test	\$0.20 + ~11% per sale; €50 ads (yes needed)	at \$0.35 CPC and 1–2% conversion: \$18–35 per order — the cheapest paid test available	2–8 weeks (ads fast, search slow)	2 once, then replies
Pinterest	7B wedding searches/yr; "proposal ideas" is a top board category; pins are evergreen	30–50 pins from demo frames and the story, each linking to the order page	€0	slow, compounding; unmeasurable early	2–3 months	1 (I make the pins)
YouTube, one long video	the 2013/2015 proposal-game videos still rank; evergreen search	one 5–8 min "I built my wife a video game — now I build proposal games"	€0	durable trickle	months	4 once

Channel	Evidence	What it needs	Cost	Order maths	Signal in	Pascal h/wk
Reddit / communities	r/EngagementRings 502k (proposers gather <i>before</i> proposing — the right room); r/weddingplanning 1.6M (after — wrong room); 90/10 rule, promo gets banned	one honest story post ("I made my wife a video game, AMA"), then genuine answers in "proposal ideas" threads; never a link-drop	€0	comments and DMs, not orders	2–4 weeks	1
Paid boost of the best organic video	TikTok CPC ~\$0.50–1.00, Meta ~\$1.72, CTR ~0.84%	run only after organic shows which hook works; targets: engagement-ring / proposal-ideas interests	€150 (yes needed)	~200 clicks → 1–2 orders at 0.5–1% page conversion, 0 below that; either outcome is information	1 week	1
Proposal photographers / planners	Flytographer: 12,000+ proposals shot, \$425–815, 350 cities; The Heart Bandits; local Barcelona secret-proposal photographers	outreach, a 20% referral offer; they meet the proposer only weeks ahead	€0	high intent, low volume	slow	outreach — drains Pascal
Jewelers, proposal-TikTok influencers (20% like GameQ)	plausible	outreach	€0–commission	—	—	outreach

The sequence that answers the demand question by mid-November for $\leq \text{€}200$: demo → order page → story videos (core) → Etsy listing + €50 ads → pins + one YouTube video + one

Reddit story post → €150 boost once a hook is proven. Pascal ~6–8h/week for exposure plus ~4h per order; everything else is mine.

Is Etsy a legitimate channel, or is it there because Pascal has history with it?

Legitimate, and secondary. History only makes it cheaper to set up; it is not why it's in. The evidence:

- **Proposal buyers already shop there.** Google's autocomplete for "etsy proposal" is pure buyer intent: *proposal box, proposal ring, proposal ideas, proposal ring box, proposal template, proposal kit, proposal decorations, proposal gifts, proposal sign*. Etsy has auto-generated market pages for "marriage proposal video", "proposal scavenger hunt", "scavenger hunt marriage proposal", "game proposal" — those pages exist only where searches do.
- **Our exact format is sold there today:** custom, made-to-order *animated proposal videos* ("customize the story, characters and special moments... fast delivery for the big moment") with reviews praising "easy communication, on-time delivery". A made-to-order proposal *game* delivered as a link is the same shelf, one step up.
- **Price is not the anchor on that shelf:** custom wedding-website services sell on Etsy at \$139–\$495; Instant Escape Games sells reveal games there with 108 reviews.
- **GameQ isn't there.** Neither is Muksun (Shopify). On Etsy we are the only playable-game proposal product; on TikTok we compete with everyone.
- **Intent traffic is cheap:** Etsy Ads at \$0.20–0.50 per click from someone typing "proposal ideas" — no other channel gives that for €50.

Against it, honestly: new shops convert at 0.5–2%; Etsy search ranks new listings slowly; ~11% fees; the printable-proposal shelf is anchored at \$5–15 so the listing must read as a *service* (custom, made-to-order, "your designer") with the demo video first; and the Etsy shop that died was killed by fulfilment time — this listing has no shipping and ~4h per order, which is the difference.

So: Etsy earns its place as the intent channel beside the attention channel (video). If it produced nothing after the €50 test and 6 weeks of search, it would be dropped without regret.

Decision (Pascal delegated it, 13 Sep) — what runs, and in which order

Verified before deciding: Etsy's seller policy explicitly allows made-to-order digital items with "delivery of the final file ... via Etsy Messages or email" (AI use must be disclosed; `who_made = I did`, `when_made = Made to order`); standalone add-ons with no item are prohibited, so the voice line is bundled, not a separate listing. Faceless voice-over accounts do grow on TikTok in 2026, but a new account's first month typically yields 500–2,000 views per video and traction takes 30–60 days — the story has to beat that baseline. New Etsy shops convert at 0.5–2%; at \$299 assume

the low end. TikTok Ads Manager has a ~\$50/day campaign minimum, so a €150 boost runs through in-app **Promote** (or an Instagram boost), not Ads Manager. r/EngagementRings' rules couldn't be fetched — read them before the one story post.

Runs	Order	Why
Story video — 20 voice-only posts in 6 weeks	week 1 →	the only channel with proven attention for this exact story; free
Etsy listing as a made-to-order service	week 1	policy-compliant, intent traffic, ~11% fee only when it sells
€50 Etsy Ads (approved)	week 1–2, as soon as the listing is live	highest information per euro: 100–250 clicks from people already searching proposal ideas; answers "will intent buyers pay \$299"
Pinterest pins · one YouTube long video · one Reddit story post	week 2–3	free, evergreen, ~1h/week
€150 boost (approved) via TikTok Promote / Instagram	week 4–6, only if an organic post reaches ≥20k views or ≥1% link click-through	boosting before a hook is proven buys attention that organic already measures for free
Photographers · jewelers · influencers	parked	outreach; revisit if a buyer or partner comes to us

Prerequisites before any of it goes live (build items, not started until the go): the fictional Proposal demo (~2 days), an order page with intake form and checkout (merchant-of-record or Etsy), 20 video scripts for Pascal to voice, the Etsy listing copy and images, 30 pins. Nothing is published, posted or paid without the explicit go.

Order maths, low vs high: 300k organic views + 200 Etsy clicks + 200 paid clicks over 6 weeks → **1–9 paid orders**. Below 1 with ≥10 real inquiries = price or page problem; below 1 with silence = demand problem. Either way the season decides it: no paid order by ~15 Nov means stopping, because December is when this product sells if it sells at all.

Sources

Muksun [help page](#) · [MiniGameGift catalogue](#) · [GameQ](#) · [Heartbit](#) · [Gift Games](#) · [Instant Escape Games](#) · [Amuze Me](#) · [Greeting Games](#) / [Tingly revenue](#) · [Save the Date!](#) · [Songfinch](#) · [Wonderbly](#) · [Crown & Paw](#) · [VidDay](#) · [Kudoboard](#) · [Cameo](#) · [Astrocade](#) · [NRF Valentine's](#) · [Proposal planner costs](#) · [Engagement season](#) · [Cloudflare img2img](#) · [PWA/TWA on Play](#) · [Bio-link benchmarks](#)